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147. Larionova, “Vozmozhnosti sotrudnichestva v BRIKS%.”

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149. “Currency Exchange Protects Trade with China,” *Linha Direta*, June 26, 2012, http://www.pt-sp.org.br/noticia/p/?acao=vernoticia&id=13767.

150. “Dmitri Medvedev Addressed the World Economic Forum in Davos,” President of Russia, January 26, 2011, http://en.kremlin.ru/events/president/news/10163.

151. Owen Fletcher, “China, France to Launch Yuan SDR Task Force,” *Wall Street Journal*, August 26, 2011.

152. “China Moves Closer to Renminbi Inclusion in SDR,” CentralBanking.com, as cited in Larionova, “Vozmozhnosti sotrudnichestva v BRIKS%.”

153. From then through August 2015, when it had its own mini–financial crisis, China’s currency continued to be close to the value of the U.S. dollar, with a modest nominal appreciation, after which the yuan fell, again modestly.

154. A senior Brazilian trade negotiator and a highly placed economic official each made this point to one of the authors in interviews in mid-2015.

155. Alena Chechel, Scott Rose, and Jack Jordan, “Putin Denounces American Parasite While Russia Increases Treasuries 1,600%,” *Bloomberg*, August 18, 2011, http://www.bloomberg.com/news/2011-08-18/putin-slams-u-s-parasite-after-1-600-jump-in-russia-holdings.html.

156. Note that Russia’s total international reserves (including gold) skyrocketed from 12,948 (January 31, 2000) to a high of 596,566 (July 31, 2008), recovering after the global financial crisis to 545,012 again on August 31, 2011. (Sums are equivalent to millions of U.S. dollars.) Central Bank of the Russian Federation data, http://www.cbr.ru/. Although the U.S. Treasury does not fully report foreign holdings of securities, it also appears that in March 2014, in response to the threat of sanctions, Russia may have shifted a significant percentage of its holdings of U.S. debt into a custodial foreign account to avoid repatriating them into rubles or having them seized by Washington.

157. The yen also is problematic due to Japan’s ongoing economic problems and long-standing reluctance to promote its international use, and Switzerland is too small a country to provide a widely